



Opt for nonalcoholic drinks if you're trying to get pregnant. A high intake of alcohol can adversely affect your chances of conceiving.

HAVING MEDICAL CHECKS

Before you try to conceive, speak to your doctor about the following tests:

- **Rubella:** have a blood test to check that you have antibodies against rubella (German measles). Being infected by the rubella virus for the first time in early pregnancy is associated with an increased risk of the baby developing hearing or sight problems, as well as increasing the risk of miscarriage. If you were vaccinated against rubella as a child, your antibody level may be high enough to protect your baby. If not, you will be offered two MMR injections three months apart. You must wait one month after the second vaccine before conceiving.
- **Screening for infectious disease:** Talk to your doctor about screening for gonorrhea, chlamydia, syphilis, HIV, and hepatitis B and C. If you have an increased risk for tuberculosis (TB), you should be screened and treated for TB before pregnancy.